

HIMACHAL PRADESH

SAINJ
HAKUSHU

Equally suited to families, couples and solo travellers, this one-bedroom cabin is an ideal getaway. A 90-minute drive from the Kullu-Manali airport, the strikingly designed, minimalistic A-frame cabin comes with a modern kitchen, living space and a bedroom on the mezzanine floor. The views from its all-glass, 20-feet-high triangular front are altogether staggering. (Rs 7,000 with breakfast plus taxes; hushstays.com)

DON'T MISS: A picnic lunch organised by the stay on the banks of the nearby Giri river.

RATNARI
MEENABAGH

If 'offbeat travel' is what you are after, drive 85 km from Shimla and spend a relaxed weekend at this four-bedroom restored cottage. The brainchild of permaculturist and ex-journalist Sanjay Austa, Meenabagh is where sustainable living meets luxury. Start your day by working on the farm, befriend the property's permanent residents—ducks, cats and the lovable dog Beswa—and tuck in some of that splendid apple cinnamon jelly. When the day is over, soak yourself in the hot tub, or enjoy a glass of wine in the dining area. (Rs 49,800 per night, inclusive of taxes; meenabaghhomes.com)

DON'T MISS: A session at their in-house observatory, which houses the country's largest privately owned telescope.

PALAMPUR
THE LODGE AT WAH

Whether on the tea estate they run, or at the Lodge at Wah (the estate's extension), sustainability is more than a buzzword for the Prakash family. Their ethic quickly becomes manifest when they take you on a walk or a tea-tasting tour. Away from the main building are two independent cottages with two units each, beautifully built in upcyled wood. When here, you can also paraglide in Bir, or try your hand at pottery in Andretta. Even Dharamshala is only an hour away. (Rs 26,000 plus taxes with breakfast and dinner for a two-room cottage; thelodgeatwah.com).

DON'T MISS: The Kangra thali, a speciality of the region, served here.





Meenabagh, Ratnari